Revision:
08/01/2020

Background:
Customers applying or reapplying for CalFresh must be interviewed prior to initial certification and recertification. There are no changes due to State legislation, this section is being re-formatted after sunset review.

Purpose:
This section describes the policies for the interview process.

Policy:
An interview must be completed at initial certification and at least once every 12 months thereafter. An interview must be completed by phone unless the customer is unable to do so or request otherwise. The interview must be completed with the head of household, their spouse, a designated Authorized Representative (AR) or another responsible household member. Customers can ask any person they choose to attend the interview. Confidentiality guidelines must be preserved when interviewing the customer.

Note: Elderly Simplified Application Project (ESAP) cases will require an interview at initial certification. The recertification interview requirements for ESAP cases are outlined in CFPG 63-360.

1. Interview Requirements:

A review of the application to determine if the information is consistent with what has been reported or is known to the county must be completed to assist staff with the interview. During the interview staff must explore, clarify, and resolve any unclear or inconsistent information with the customer. Customers must also be informed of the Rights & Responsibilities, and reporting requirements, including how to complete the SAR 7. When there are pending verifications, staff must explain why the verifications are needed and offer assistance in obtaining them. Provide the customer with a printed copy of the Statement of Facts for their records. Case Comments must be entered detailing all the information obtained and shared during the interview.

2. Face-to-Face or Home Visit Interviews:

Customers that do not have a phone, are unable to come into the office due to a hardship or prefer to not to complete the interview by phone may be scheduled for a face-to-face or home visit interview. The reason for face-to-face or home visit interview must be documented in case comments.

3. Language Needs:

Non-English-speaking customers must be informed of their right to have an interpreter, and when available, must receive the forms in the customers preferred language. The “Language Needs” form is required for all cases, regardless of the customer’s language. Refer to the Civil Rights Eligibility Policy and Procedures Guide for information on providing services to non-English speaking customers and customers with disabilities.

4. Missed Interview:

When a customer misses their scheduled interview, a Notice of Missed Interview (NOMI) must be sent. The NOMI informs the customer that they need to reschedule the interview. When the customer does not reschedule the interview, or reschedules and fails to attend subsequent interviews, the

application will be denied on the 30th day. The customer will be mailed the Notice of Action (NOA) "Notice of Denial of Pending Status" on or after the 30th day following the date of application. Customers who reschedule and fail to attend subsequent interviews will not be mailed additional NOMI's.

When a customer contacts the county and the county fails to reschedule the initial interview within 30 days of the date the application was filed, it will be considered county caused delay. Refer to 63-109 for policies regarding time limits and delays in application processing.

Other Program Impacts:
None

References:
ACL 09-62
MPP 63-300.4

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 08/31/2023

Approval for Release:

8-27-20

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Eligibility Operations